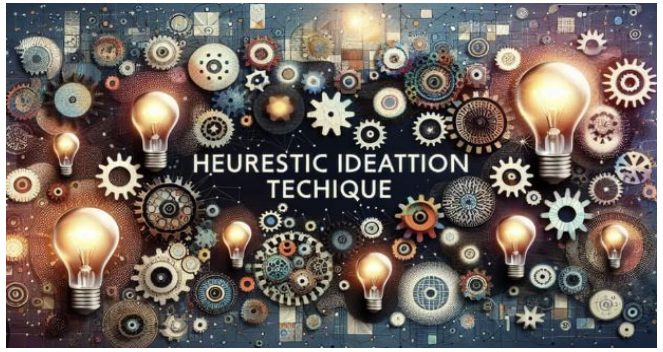
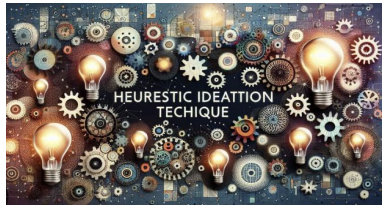


Heuristic Ideation Technique (HIT)

Heuristic ideation is a structured creativity framework that generates new ideas by systemically breaking two products or systems into key attributes and combining one element from each to stimulate novel solutions.

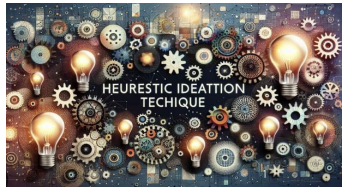
Aurora Caton

Systematic Idea Generation



- Creative Problem-Solving Framework
  - Focuses on generating new ideas by breaking down the structure of existing products into lists of factors or attributes (Proctor, 2014)
- Process
  - Listing key factors or attributes of two different products or systems, pairing one element from each list, and treating each pairing as a prompt for idea generation.
- Disciplined, Repeatable Method for Innovation
  - Encourages people to explore unconventional connections and reframe problems from different perspectives. Enables people to generate a broad range of creative solutions rather than relying on intuition or incremental thinking.

Heuristic Ideation Technique Template



Domain A: Target System	**Domain B: Reference System- Attribute 1**	**Attribute 2**	**Attribute 3**	**Attribute 4**
Attribute A1	Idea 1A	Idea 1B	Idea 1C	Idea 1D
Attribute A2	Idea 2A	Idea 2B	Idea 2C	Idea 2D
Attribute A3	Idea 3A	Idea 3B	Idea 3C	Idea 3D
Attribute A4	Idea 4A	Idea 4B	Idea 4C	Idea 4D

HIT Solution Prompt

Heuristic ideation is a structured creativity framework that generates new ideas by systemically breaking two products or systems into key attributes and combining one element from each to stimulate novel solutions. This technique works by Listing key factors or attributes of two different products or systems, pairing one element from each list, and treating each pairing as a prompt for idea generation. Using the template shown in the screenshot that I uploaded, help me implement the heuristic ideation technique for the following problem: My technology company generates a high volume of user behavior and system performance data, but data analysts struggle to identify meaningful insights quickly because dashboards and alerts are designed around static metrics rather than how different users, systems, or risks actually interact in real time.

HIT Solution Framework

Heuristic Ideation Combination Matrix

Domain A: Analytics System	Triage Prioritization (B1)	Patient History (B2)	Severity Scoring (B3)	Escalation Pathways (B4)
Data Visualization (A1)	Dashboards automatically reorder charts based on highest-risk signals first	Visualizations show historical user or system behavior trends inline	Visual cues (color, size) represent real-time risk severity	Dashboards visually indicate which teams or tools should respond
Alert Generation (A2)	Alerts are ranked and surfaced based on urgency, not volume	Alerts include recent system/user context to reduce false positives	Alerts carry a dynamic risk score instead of binary thresholds	Alerts route automatically to appropriate teams based on severity
User Segmentation (A3)	Users are grouped by risk level rather than static demographics	Segments incorporate behavioral history over time	Segments dynamically update based on severity changes	High-risk segments trigger escalation protocols automatically
Analyst Workflow (A4)	Analyst queues are ordered by highest-impact issues	Investigation tools preload relevant historical data	Analysts see a real-time severity score during analysis	Clear handoff paths exist for escalating issues to engineering/security

HIT Solution Framework (Continued)

- **Domain A (Target System):**
  - **Data analytics dashboards & alerting system** at a tech company
- **Domain B (Reference System):**
  - **Healthcare triage system**
    (Chosen because it prioritizes urgency, context, and real-time risk — very similar to analytics + monitoring problems)

- Each cell represents a **new idea generated by combining one attribute of the analytics system with one attribute of a healthcare triage system**, allowing analysts to rethink dashboards and alerts in terms of urgency, context, and interaction rather than static metrics.